PRINCE2 | P2-02

Project Brief

Baseline for the Initiating a Project process

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Project Brief
Document reference	*P2-02-HEL-T2-v1.0*
Project / Programme	*Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build*
Version	*1.0*
Status	*Baselined*
Date	*18 Sep 2026*
Author	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*
Owner	*Project Manager*
Approver	*Project Board (Directing a Project — Authorise Initiation)*
Classification	*Internal*
Retention	*7 years from programme closure*

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	*04 Jun 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Initial draft*
0.2	*21 Jul 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Updated following workstream lead review*
1.0	*18 Sep 2026*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate*

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	*Chief Platform Architect*	*Technical content and solution alignment*	*08 Sep 2026*
L. Haddad, CISO	*CISO*	*Security, assurance and residency content*	*10 Sep 2026*
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	*Finance Business Partner*	*Cost, funding and benefit figures*	*11 Sep 2026*
M. Verity, Head of P3O	*Head of P3O*	*Governance standards and completeness*	*15 Sep 2026*

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	*Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO*	*Approved*	*18 Sep 2026*
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	*Director of Infrastructure*	*Approved*	*18 Sep 2026*
L. Haddad, CISO	*CISO*	*Approved subject to closure of ISS-003*	*18 Sep 2026*

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
P2-01	Project Mandate	Source input
P2-03	Project Product Description	Appendix to this brief
P2-04	Business Case	Outline case included here
P2-10	Project Initiation Documentation	Extends this brief

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Provides a full and firm foundation for the initiation of the project, used by the Project Board to decide whether to authorise initiation.
Framework	PRINCE2 — Created in Starting up a Project; baselined at the Initiation Stage boundary
Created when	Starting up a Project (SU)
Reviewed / updated	At the end of Initiating a Project — extended into the PID and not maintained thereafter
Owner	Project Manager
Approver	Project Board (Directing a Project — Authorise Initiation)
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It is brief — this is a foundation, not the PID
- The project definition is unambiguous and testable
- The outline Business Case reflects the Project Mandate and organisational strategy
- The project approach considers a realistic range of delivery options
- Roles and responsibilities are agreed by the named individuals
- It can stand alone as the basis for a decision to authorise initiation

Contents

1. Project definition

Background

Context and the events leading to the project. Reference the Project Mandate.

Project objectives

Express objectives in terms of the six performance targets: time, cost, quality, scope, benefits and risk. Make each measurable.

Target	Objective	Tolerance (indicative)
Time	*Three tenants can run concurrently on hall A with fair-share quota enforced under contention*	*60 minutes*
Cost	*Low-priority training jobs can be pre-empted and resumed without loss of work*	*AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation*
Quality	*Only signed container images from the internal registry can run on the estate*	*No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full*
Scope	*Nodes failing firmware attestation are quarantined automatically at admission*	*In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.*
Benefits	*Each tenant receives a monthly consumption statement that reconciles to telemetry*	*No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation*
Risk	*GPU telemetry is available at 10-second resolution with 13-month retention*	*No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance*

Desired outcomes

The result of the change derived from using the project's outputs.

Project scope and exclusions

State clearly what is in and what is deliberately out. Exclusions prevent scope creep more effectively than inclusions.

Constraints and assumptions

Ref	Constraint / assumption	Type	Impact if invalid
ASM-001	*Vendor GPU allocation of 2,048 units for Tranche 2 will be honoured at the quoted delivery dates*	*Assumption*	*Tranche 2 completion slips by at least one quarter and contract terms are renegotiated*
ASM-002	*DXB-1 has 6 MVA of usable capacity available to the programme without a utility upgrade*	*Assumption*	*Tranche 2 capped at 1,024 GPUs and the AUH-2 site is brought forward two quarters*
ASM-003	*Three business units will migrate committed workloads within six months of hall A handover*	*Assumption*	*Utilisation benefit of AED 14.2m over five years is not realised in full*
ASM-004	*Training data classified as Restricted must remain within UAE borders at rest and in transit*	*Constraint*	*Not applicable — this is a fixed constraint on design*
ASM-005	*Liquid cooling maintenance can be absorbed by the existing facilities contract without an uplift*	*Assumption*	*Annual run cost increases by approximately AED 780,000*

The user(s) and any other known interested parties

Party	Role / interest	Contact
Owned within WS4 Platform and orchestration	*Business Owners and tenant representatives*	*J. Ferreira, Network Lead*
Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail	*CISO and Security Architect*	*I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead*
Subject to closure of ISS-003 before multi-tenant go-live	*Programme Manager and workstream leads*	*K. Adeyemi, Security Architect*
Constrained by the 6.2 MVA site limit at DXB-1 until 2028	*Programme Board*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*

Interfaces

Interfaces the project must maintain with other projects, operational services, suppliers, regulators or programmes.

2. Outline Business Case

Sufficient to justify authorising initiation. The full Business Case is developed during Initiating a Project.

Reason

Why the project is needed.

Expected benefits and dis-benefits (indicative)

Indicative cost and timescale

Major risks to viability

3. Project Product Description

Attach or reference template P2-03. Do not duplicate.

In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.

4. Project approach

How the work will be delivered — build, buy, adapt, outsource, phased, contracted. Show the options considered and why the selected approach was chosen.

Option	Description	Advantages	Disadvantages	Selected
Do nothing	*400G RoCEv2 leaf-spine fabric tuned for collective communication at 256-GPU job scale*	*Lowest residual risk to the residency obligation*	*Higher run cost from FY28*	*Yes*
Option A — add a second CDU to hall A	*Liquid-cooled racks at 60 kW with rear-door heat exchangers and CDU redundancy at N+1*	*Keeps the critical path clear of supplier lead times*	*Defers benefit realisation by one quarter*	*No*
Option B — accept 48 kW density and cap at 1,536 GPUs	*Consolidate all AI training workloads onto a shared 2,048-GPU platform in DXB-1 halls A and B*	*Fastest route to a testable increment*	*Increases supplier concentration (RSK-009)*	*Yes*
Do nothing	*Liquid-cooled racks at 60 kW with rear-door heat exchangers and CDU redundancy at N+1*	*Reuses proven Tranche 1 patterns*	*Requires scarce platform engineering capacity*	*No*

5. Project management team structure

Insert or reference an organisation chart showing the Project Board, Project Manager, Team Managers, Project Assurance and Project Support.

The Programme Board meets monthly, chaired by the Group CTO as Senior Responsible Owner, with the Director of Infrastructure, CISO, Finance Business Partner and the three consuming business unit heads. Delivery workstreams report weekly to the Programme Manager. The Agile Release Train holds PI planning quarterly, with Business Owners drawn from the same board. The P3O provides assurance, reporting standards and the RAID consolidation.

6. Role descriptions

Attach role descriptions for each appointment. Confirm each named individual has accepted the role.

Role	Name	Organisation	Accepted (date)
Executive	*H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure*	*H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure*	*H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure*
Senior User	*F. Mansour, Business Change Lead*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*18 Sep 2026*
Senior Supplier	*M. Verity, Head of P3O*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*18 Sep 2026*
Project Manager	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*
Team Manager(s)	*E. Santos, Procurement Lead*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*18 Sep 2026*
Project Assurance	*R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*18 Sep 2026*
Project Support	*R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO*	*Group Technology — Infrastructure and Platform*	*18 Sep 2026*
Change Authority	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*	*D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager*

7. References

Documents that informed the brief — strategy papers, audit reports, policies, standards, prior lessons.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Reviewed at each PI boundary by the Release Train Engineer. Detail is maintained by the Project Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.